

## Chapter 87-2 - Secret (Part 1)

"Purple Mist Peak really is just like the Divine Venerable herself - so lonely and isolated. There are no other mountains around, just this one shooting up from the ground," Jiuying said, shaking her head and looking around, rubbing her arms where goosebumps had formed from the wind.

"Sister Jiuying, you should put something on too," Baili Shiqi offered her cloak to Jiuying, but Jiuying dodged away.

"I'm a divine beast - why would I need such mortal cold-weather gear?" she said with pursed red lips.

"But all your scales are gone, leaving you bare. Naturally you'd be cold," Baili Shiqi said seriously.

"You little girl!" Jiuying was halfway through speaking when she shivered, delicately taking the cloak with her orchid-like fingers and reluctantly putting it on.

Baili Shiqi glanced at the silent Ning Fuyi: "Sister Ning..."

"It's fine, let's go up," Ning Fuyi smiled and took the lead up the mountain path.

Purple Mist Peak was no different from when she usually came - cold and desolate. The stone palace sat solidly on the bare ground. Ning Fuyi searched through the sleeping quarters, but found nothing except those heavenly books.

She then went to Qiu Yi's residence. The decor here remained as it was before - luxurious and extravagant, very much like a mortal princess's boudoir.

She hadn't paid attention then, but looking at these somewhat aged furnishings now, Ning Fuyi suddenly imagined the scene of Chu Qingqiu, who never concerned herself with worldly affairs, bringing back a mortal child and fumbling to acquire all these mortal items.

The best food, clothing, and necessities - yet her own hall contained only cold stones.

Chu Qingqiu was indeed a good master. This was also the reason she had secretly envied Qiu Yi in her previous life. Ning Fuyi took out the small sprout from the thought bead, watching as it shivered and burrowed into the soil after touching the cold wind.

"You're home," Ning Fuyi said softly, using her palm to shield the small sprout from the cold wind, her tone so gentle it seemed it could warm away all the cold.

Jiuying nearby looked up at the sky with her golden eyes and squeezed out a shrill voice: "Oh my, I hate Chu Qingqiu, I want to question her and torment her..."

"Qi Jiuying," Ning Fuyi turned around protectively holding the small sprout, giving Jiuying a deep look. Only then did Jiuying close her mouth.

"Now we've looked at all these stone palaces, and there's nothing unusual in any of them," Jiuying changed the subject. "What should we do?"

"Eh, Sister Ning, there's still one room we haven't been to," Baili Shiqi pointed to the most remote stone palace. "Why don't we take a look?"

Hearing this, Ning Fuyi looked up and carefully set down the glazed cup.

"That's not Chu Qingqiu's place - it's my mother Ning Changfeng's," Ning Fuyi walked over, and when she approached the hall, she reached out to wipe away the dust on the door.

"When I was a child, I stayed here with my mother, but after that I never came to Purple Mist Peak again, so I never went inside," Ning Fuyi said with nostalgia in her eyes. Immortal power flowed from her fingertips and the door slowly opened.

A damp, musty breath emanated from within. The three held their breath as they entered. Inside was pitch black with no windows. Jiuying raised her hand to light a lamp, finally illuminating the dim stone chamber.

Though remotely located, the stone chamber had corridors, main halls, and bedrooms - nothing was missing. But everything was bare, not even a single teacup left behind.

"I think there's still nothing here. Perhaps what Chu Qingqiu left for you isn't at Purple Mist Peak at all. I think we should go back to Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate to look..." Jiuying walked and sniffed as she went, even sneezing.

"Wait," Ning Fuyi suddenly stopped. She looked up at a huge stone cabinet and used immortal power to move it aside.

Behind the stone cabinet was a wall, but in the center there seemed to be an array formation drawn in ink. Ning Fuyi stepped forward to examine it carefully: "It's the Bedrock Array<sup>1</sup>. Once this array is activated, this place becomes indestructible."

How could there be an array formation remaining in Ning Changfeng's temporary residence? Ning Fuyi's eyes darkened as she placed her hand on it and felt around carefully, then pressed on a soft spot and pushed down hard.

The array formation opened left and right, revealing a small hole just big enough for a person to reach their hand into.

Ning Fuyi and Jiuying looked at each other, both nodding simultaneously as they placed the jade pendant inside.

Instantly, the wall began to move. Baili Shiqi nearly lost her footing, but Ning Fuyi raised her hand to steady her, pulling her behind herself.

"Thank you, Sister Ning," Baili Shiqi said quietly.

Ning Fuyi's full attention was on the cave. The door had now completely opened, and the musty smell of old books wafted out from the secret chamber. Ning Fuyi held her breath and summoned pink light, throwing a ball of it inside to illuminate the secret chamber.

"My heavens," Jiuying murmured in shock, cautiously transforming beast claws as she entered. "It's so spacious inside."

The secret chamber was as large as an entire stone palace, with an equally massive stone table in the center. The table was piled high with ancient books and fragments, along with scattered papers.

The papers were covered with various array formations - all formations Ning Fuyi had never seen before. She clenched her teeth and quickly walked to the stone table, picking up those ancient books and fragments to examine them closely.

"All array formations," Ning Fuyi looked down and rummaged through the books scattered on the floor. "These too. Why does Chu Qingqiu's token open my mother's door? And why did Ning Changfeng create so many array formations?"

Her head began to ache again. She suddenly stood up and looked around, seeing that the surrounding walls were also covered with array formations. Various arrays were layered on top of each other, all drawn with ink fused with immortal power, meant to last forever.

Standing in such a cramped and chaotically cluttered place, both Jiuying and Baili Shiqi felt dizzy and disoriented.

"With so many array formations layered upon each other, your mother must have been drawing them for hundreds or thousands of years," Jiuying said in amazement, looking at each one. "And these ancient books - some are older than me. What did she collect them for?"

Baili Shiqi was also crouching in a corner looking through things: "I've heard of Sect Leader Ningtian's<sup>2</sup> reputation. Everyone says her greatest strength wasn't her cultivation or immortal techniques, but this mechanical arts and array formations. In these two areas, she was a once-in-ten-thousand-years genius."

"Looking at this now, it's truly so. So many different array formations - I couldn't think them up even if I racked my brains," Baili Shiqi said, looking left and right at two tortoise shells in her hands.

"So what is this Divine Venerable trying to tell you? Could it be that your mother has some array formation that can bring people back from the dead to save the Divine Venerable?" Jiuying pondered, propping up her chin.

"If there were an array formation for resurrection, my mother would have used it on herself long ago," Ning Fuyi said, her mind in complete chaos. She quickly flipped through the thousands upon thousands of stacked papers and books, trying to find something. "She wouldn't have waited until..."

Ning Fuyi's words stopped abruptly. She stared at a stack of papers that looked most recent, her scalp tingling from shock.

She bit her lip until it bled, then tremblingly picked up that stack of papers and brought them to her eyes.

The array formation was too familiar. Though it wasn't exactly the same, this was an array formation Ning Fuyi had tried to set up countless times in her previous life, so she recognized it at a glance.

"Isn't this array formation from ancient scrolls? How could it be drawn by Ning Changfeng..." She tried hard to open her eyes wide, opening them until her eye sockets were red.

At that time, she had lost all hope and decided to risk everything, using the array formation recorded in the ancient scrolls she had discovered - one that could bring people back from the dead - to revive her deceased loved ones and friends, at the cost of blood sacrifice.

It was precisely when she was preparing to activate the array formation that day that she received Chu Qingqiu's sword strike and was able to be reborn.

But what was written on these papers now wasn't the word "resurrection."

It was "reincarnation."

So this wasn't a resurrection array formation at all, but the cause of her rebirth - the Reincarnation Array!

"Ning Changfeng, Mother," she pressed her fist against her mouth, suppressing the tears about to fall, murmuring to herself. "What on earth is going on?"

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### Footnotes:

1. **Bedrock Array (磐石阵):** A defensive array formation that makes structures incredibly durable and indestructible
2. **Sect Leader Ningtian (凝天掌门):** Ning Changfeng's title as the leader of her sect; "Ningtian" literally means "Condensing Heaven"